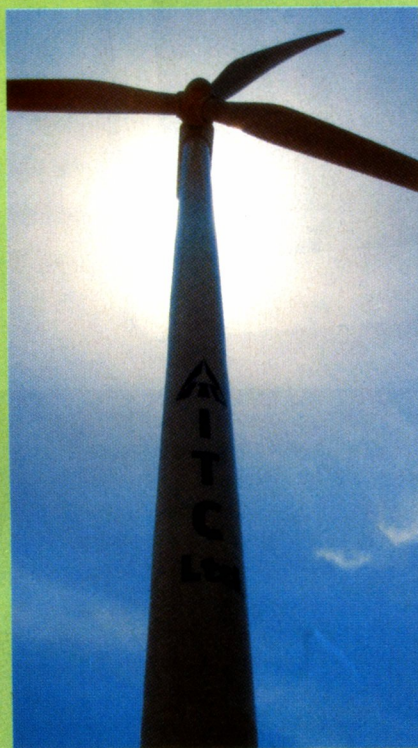


GREEN TECH

ITC

**PROJECT: Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation**

AIM: To combat climate change by adopting strategies which achieve energy efficiency benchmarks and de-risk various businesses.

Company plants trees for wood pulp for its paperboard business, conserves energy by using renewable energy in its plants and harvests more rainwater than it uses. ITC Sonar, a hotel in Kolkata, is a CDM project and earns carbon credits through its green operations.

IMPACT: The only Indian company which is carbon and water positive. It saves CO₂ emissions of 3,695 ktonnes through sequestration while it emits 1,572 ktonnes.

power streetlights. In water conservation we meet 52 per cent of our water requirement with recycled water. At 19 of our major locations, we have state-of-the-art sewage treatment plants." Apart from conserving resources, Wipro is also focusing on greening its data centres, the nerve centre of any technology company as it houses the servers. Wipro has designed and implemented its data centres in such a way that the company saves 20,160 units of electricity in a month, saving 45 kg of CO₂ per annum of total GHG emissions.

While it is conservation for some companies, for others regulatory pressures are defining new business paradigms. Consumer goods company ITC has a different approach to doing business. Rather than look only at profitability as its objective, the company is also ironically looking at enhancing social

and ecological returns while doing business. It started many years ago when it was confronted with a significant challenge in its paperboards business due to the lack of availability of cost-effective fibre. The company chose to mobilise marginal farmers and tribals to plant trees on their private wastelands. Today, this programme covers over 90,000 hectares and has provided nearly 39 million man-days of employment. This green cover has also enabled ITC to

achieve the unique distinction of being a carbon positive company for four consecutive years.

The company's conscious strategy to shed reliance on cheaper imports and instead invest in longer term benefits of promoting plantations has yielded positive results. A business which was nearly sick a decade ago is today not only a world-class producer of environment-friendly, state-of-the-art elemental chlorine-free paper and paperboard but is also the only one of its kind in the country. Apart from this, the company's renewable sources of energy contributed to 30 per cent of its total energy needs in 2008-09 compared to 24.1 per cent in 2007-08. Says Subhash Rastogi, vice-president of environment, health and safety at ITC: "Indian companies face major social and environmental challenges today, which need to be addressed. At ITC, our philosophy is to conserve natural resources. We currently have seven projects under CDM, which help us earn carbon credit. This apart, our energy conservation has saved us at least Rs 15-20 crore in a year."

This may be the story of a handful of Indian companies, but most still have miles to go. Except the top 250 companies in India, others are not even concerned about their carbon footprint. Anticipating a change in the environment post-2012, the CII last year started a centre of excellence, the Godrej Green Business Centre, to support Indian companies attain world standards in emissions and sustainability. Says S. Raghu-pathy, senior director and head, CII-Godrej GBC: "So far only 277 companies which want to be world-class in energy efficiency have registered with us. By 2010, companies which are heavy on CO₂ emissions will face problems if they do not act now." Clearly, it's a case of now or never for corporate India. ■

2010

is the year by which companies heavy on CO₂ emissions are likely to face business problems.